

6. Root Cause #3 – SHORTs in a Rising Tape

This is the dominant root cause by P&L impact.

6.1 The fix is working – and that's the problem

The SHORT-arm slot partition (deployed 04-23 → 04-24) is doing exactly what it was designed to do. Today's prod logs are full of:

```
[11:07:41] SUNPHARMA: BLOCKED (LONG slot cap reached (15/15 in SIDEWAYS
[11:07:41] ADANIPOWER: BLOCKED (LONG slot cap reached (15/15 in SIDEWAY
[11:07:41] BLUESTARCO: BLOCKED (LONG slot cap reached (15/15 in SIDEWAY
[11:07:41] ZYDUSLIFE: BLOCKED (LONG slot cap reached (15/15 in SIDEWAYS
... (~14 more)
```

The engine correctly held back 5 slots for SHORTs. SHORTs then deployed. And every SHORT in a +0.63% Nifty tape is fighting the broader market.

6.2 Today's SHORT trades – every single one

v5 (29 SHORTs total — 12 wins, 17 losses, Rs –789 net):

Result	Count	P&L	Pattern
STOPLOSS hits (loss)	12	Rs -1,302	Stocks moved <i>up</i> against entry
TIME_EXIT (mostly small)	14	Rs +301	Position scratched flat after 30-min hold
TARGET hits (win)	3	Rs +212	ASTRAL × 2, TMCV × 1 — outliers

Worst SHORT losses today (across all 3 engines):